

Speaker 1 [00:00:02] Very well. Your boyfriend, indeed. How long have you been with this person?

Speaker 2 [00:00:07] It has been [1-5] and a half years.

Speaker 1 [00:00:09] Ok, very well, [1-5] and a half years.

Speaker 1 [00:00:12] But listen, I would really like you to start by telling me about the love story you are currently experiencing with your boyfriend.

Speaker 2 [00:00:21] So, with [partner]. I think this is the first time I am experiencing a relationship where everything is free—free in discussion, in sharing, and in ways of thinking. It allows us to truly open up to each other and be ourselves, which wasn't necessarily the case in previous relationships. So, I have a very beautiful relationship where we share many things and have a lot in common.

Speaker 1 [00:01:13] You mentioned that you feel a sense of freedom in this relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:01:15] Yes, the freedom to be oneself.

Speaker 1 [00:01:18] The freedom to be oneself. I would like you to perhaps talk about the foundations, how you met, and the context of this relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:01:36] We met through [App]. At the time, I had been separated for [1-5] and a half years. I was in a period where I felt that none of the men I met were mature enough—they were all jerks. And as he would tell you, he was not at all ready for a real relationship. I went for a walk with a friend, and I hadn't put any photos on [App]. I saw him, but I recognized him because [partner] had been in high school with me [16-20] years earlier. I thought I would never be able to get his contact because he wouldn't "like" me. So, I looked him up on [Social Media] to get in touch with him, and we started talking and met fairly quickly. Initially, it was really just date after date. [Partner] had a story where his ex had somewhat emasculated him, and he didn't feel like himself anymore. For him, being in a relationship meant losing his identity. We would have amazing weekends together, but by Monday or Tuesday, because we live an hour apart, I called it "the bells ringing"—the bells of the steeple ringing each week to bring us back down to earth. This went on for [1-5] or [1-5] months. At some point, maybe [1-5] months in, we might have somewhat separated. We also set some boundaries regarding the sexual aspect, understanding what he wanted and if I was ready to meet his desires. From there, once I accepted that, he opened up more, allowing us to have a real relationship. It was complicated because his children live an hour away with his ex in [Country]. To see his children as much as possible, he has a unique arrangement where he stays at his ex's place to take care of the children on certain evenings. It was very challenging for me because for the first [6-10] months, he didn't talk about me to anyone. He was still involved with his family in a particular way. Over time, he talked to his ex-in-laws about me, and things settled.

Speaker 1 [00:05:35] If I understand correctly, you mentioned a sense of emasculation, and you had to relearn how to be yourselves together in the relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:05:48] Yes. I think his ex would talk about their activities as if they didn't involve him, like "I did this with the kids." I met her once and had no preconceived notions about her. When I met her, I understood what kind of person she was. Over time, he realized that with me, there were lots of discussions, no judgment, and we shared a lot. He saw that I didn't function the same way she did. There's no comparison.

Speaker 1 [00:06:34] So, if I understand correctly, it was a way to make him invisible? Sorry, I'm listening.

Speaker 2 [00:06:45] Yes, I think that was her way of dealing with him.

Speaker 1 [00:06:46] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:06:48] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:06:50] Yes. You also briefly mentioned sexuality at one point. I'm not sure I understood the context in which you brought it up. You said it was something important for him, right, for self-discovery?

Speaker 2 [00:07:09] For self-discovery, he will talk about it too. Yes, [partner] has a need for dominance in sex. He had me fill out a questionnaire with a list of things that would be acceptable or not for me. We both completed it to see where we could meet each other. From there, we saw what I was ready to explore. [Partner] is very imaginative and always brings things in a beautiful and well-scripted way, always making you feel valued.

Speaker 1 [00:08:20] Making you feel valued.

Speaker 2 [00:08:23] It's never, well, you know, I talk about it with friends, and one friend says it's normal for couples to be into hardcore stuff, and her partner always did that with his exes. She says it's not normal, but I tell her it's not about forcing things. It's about the dominant person uplifting the submissive one and putting her on a pedestal. [Partner] knows how to do that perfectly.

Speaker 1 [00:09:10] You're talking about an ambivalent form of dominance where there is both dominance and elevation of the other.

Speaker 2 [00:09:16] Yes, exactly.

Speaker 1 [00:09:20] You mentioned earlier, when you were describing the context of your meeting, that at some point you stopped seeing each other for [1-5] months.

Speaker 2 [00:09:32] Not for [1-5] months, but it might have been after [1-5] months or a month together. [Partner] ended it because he didn't dare talk about his sexual desires, thinking I

would never accept it. He decided to end the relationship because he desired something he thought he couldn't do with me.

Speaker 1 [00:10:02] In terms of sexuality, you mean? Yes. Why do you think he didn't dare or thought it was something...

Speaker 2 [00:10:12] I don't know.

Speaker 1 [00:10:13] Yes. You mentioned at the beginning of our conversation the notion of freedom and acceptance in the relationship. I would like you to elaborate on that a bit more.

Speaker 2 [00:10:30] He desires ordinary freedom, but it's really about being oneself. Dare to say everything and talk about everything. Be free in that regard. But there are many things that might not be free to share and be oneself.

Speaker 1 [00:11:00] You said this was something different from your previous relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:11:05] Yes, because with the father of my children, it was impossible to discuss anything. There was never any real conversation about anything substantial. I think I fixated on that aspect in a relationship. We never really talked about the important things in life.

Speaker 1 [00:11:36] The important things.

Speaker 2 [00:11:37] The real things in life. Never anything in-depth, just everyday details. With [partner], he sometimes asks me questions I never even asked myself. It's really interesting.

Speaker 1 [00:12:06] Indeed, you mentioned your previous relationship. If you were to compare the quality of your current relationship with [partner] to your past relationships, what would you say?

Speaker 2 [00:12:21] If I had to compare it to life with others, I had the father of my children for a long time and then I wandered between relationships. It doesn't compare. It's like comparing... I couldn't even compare it to wine because they're both liquids, but there's such a significant difference. Comparing [partner] to others in terms of feeling supported, being lifted up—I'm very independent, but I still need support, and [partner] does that well, whereas my ex never did. He judged everything—vacations, kids, the house. It's incomparable. Even in terms of lifestyle, with [partner], we chose not to live together, at least while we have children to care for. We isolate ourselves in our bubble when we see each other, enjoying our time together. With my ex, it was always about the house and talking to others, never each other. That's the big difference between the two relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:14:45] Besides freedom and communication, you also talked about support in the relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:14:55] Yes. We're lovers, friends, and partners. There's nothing impossible for us.

Speaker 1 [00:15:05] Lovers, friends, and partners. Is it important for you to be not just lovers, but also friends and partners, as you say?

Speaker 2 [00:15:18] Just being lovers doesn't necessarily last long. If there's nothing else behind it, it's true; it needs to be a combination of things.

Speaker 1 [00:15:33] Yes. You think it needs to be a combination of many elements for it to work? I'd like you to tell me more about that.

Speaker 2 [00:15:45] Of course, it's everything we've talked about—love, esteem for each other, love for the other person, sharing, exchange, the sexual aspect, the way we see life, knowing how to question each other, accepting to hear from the other what works and what doesn't, listening to the other, respecting their needs.

Speaker 1 [00:16:35] Yes, respecting their needs. You mentioned comparing your current relationship with [partner] to your previous relationships. If you were to make the same comparison with your friends' relationships, what would you say?

Speaker 2 [00:17:03] Well, I think that in most cases, not in all, we've managed with [partner] to find a balance and avoid falling into a routine compared to other couples. The distance is not easy, but even with time, we manage to keep that spark each time we reunite. The others, as far as I know, live together, and they fall into the routine of daily life. It's harder to keep that spark.

Speaker 1 [00:18:25] Yes, you mentioned not living together and seeing each other once every two weeks plus an extra day. Is that correct?

Speaker 2 [00:18:37] One day. Currently, I'm changing my custody arrangement with my children, so it should stay roughly the same. For now, we see each other on weekends from Thursday evening to Monday morning if we don't have the kids at the same time. The following week, we see each other from Thursday evening to Friday evening until we each pick up our children. So, it's [1-5] days, [1-5] day, [1-5] days, [1-5] day.

Speaker 1 [00:19:02] Per week.

Speaker 2 [00:19:04] Yes, it's not a lot.

Speaker 1 [00:19:06] You say it's not a lot?

Speaker 2 [00:19:08] No.

Speaker 1 [00:19:10] Would you like it to be more?

Speaker 2 [00:19:12] Yes, but we can't because of work, distance, etc. If we lived five or ten minutes apart, we could afford not to live together but see each other more. It's not always easy managing the distance and the longing.

Speaker 1 [00:19:35] How do you manage the distance and the longing?

Speaker 2 [00:19:39] Initially, it was very difficult for me because on the days he didn't see me, he was at his ex's place. It was very complicated, especially since he didn't talk about it at first. Even when he did, I think I ignored it because she wanted to keep the family together for financial support. At some point, I don't remember when, but to protect myself, I tried... we clashed on that topic, and it became, unfortunately, a taboo subject. We didn't talk about her anymore. We talk about her now, but I don't know if he tells me everything.

Speaker 1 [00:20:58] So, from what I understand, it was a choice, actually.

Speaker 2 [00:21:07] Yes, yes, it's a choice, but also an imposed choice. Even if he lived five minutes away, as long as I have children at home, I don't want to, and he probably feels the same, live with someone. We want to preserve the relationship with the children and with each other. Each of us has children on our own, and I know that living together and raising someone else's children is not a sustainable way to live. I grew up with separated parents; they separated when I was [1-5]. I had a stepfather and a stepmother, and I know how difficult it is to have to raise or even tolerate, even [1-5] days a month, the education of someone else's children. I think people who get together with separated parents don't realize what it can be like.

Speaker 1 [00:22:15] Yes, because in comparison with your friends, you mentioned that living together could reinforce a certain routine, which you found detrimental to the relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:22:51] Yes, if friends can manage to live together.

Speaker 1 [00:22:56] Yes, you were talking about your friends' relationships, comparing your relationship with theirs. You said that sometimes living together could, in your opinion, harm the quality of the relationship. But at the same time, you don't live together with your boyfriend [partner]. It's both a chosen and an imposed choice, which is also difficult for you. I'd like you to talk more about this ambivalence you feel regarding this notion.

Speaker 2 [00:23:38] Geographically, it's impossible to live all together. Yes, it's hard being at a distance, but it's also hard living daily life together. I lived with someone for [11-15] years, and I know the difficulties are different. I feel much better today because, with [partner], we exchange messages all day and call each other occasionally. Even when we're not together, we're still together. I don't have the daily difficulties of managing everything for the other person. I know that with [partner], the daily routine wouldn't be the same, but it might take away the little cloud we find ourselves on when we reunite. Or maybe not, I don't know. Either way, today, the question doesn't arise. Maybe it will in a few years, but not today. With children, we don't want it, and we want to maintain the special relationships we have with each other and with our children. I enjoy seeing [partner]'s children occasionally, and maybe if I saw them regularly, I wouldn't appreciate them as much, which would be a shame.

Speaker 1 [00:25:35] Yes, for you, it's also a way to preserve the relationship and yourself.

Speaker 2 [00:25:41] Preserve ourselves and the children. I see my children living together with their dad's new partner, and it doesn't go well. It doesn't necessarily work for them either.

Speaker 1 [00:26:04] It can create conflicts. That's what you're saying? I'd like you to tell me what a high-quality relationship means to you.

Speaker 2 [00:26:19] A rich relationship—rich in exchange, love, and sharing.

Speaker 1 [00:26:29] Exchange, love, and sharing. So, how can you know you're in a relationship of love and sharing?

Speaker 2 [00:26:44] You feel it because the love you give to the other person, you feel it, and the love the other person gives you, you generally feel it too. Sharing is about daily life—sharing when we're together, sharing ideas, values, passions, moments. With [partner], even cooking together is a shared moment. We might not do big things, but small things together feel like special moments.

Speaker 1 [00:27:36] Taking time for the other person.

Speaker 2 [00:27:38] Yes, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:27:42] When would you say your relationship has been the most about sharing?

Speaker 2 [00:27:57] It's difficult because we are always sharing. Every time we see each other, the first evening is about reuniting and having a drink, talking for hours. We share so many things—the outdoors, post-COVID ideas, and things that not everyone agrees with. We share a lot. I don't have one particular moment of sharing with [partner] because my life with him is a continuous share.

Speaker 1 [00:29:00] Yes, I understand what you mean. Conversely, when would you say your relationship was the least about sharing?

Speaker 2 [00:29:15] When I impose taboos on certain topics, like his ex or things that hurt me. These taboos come from me when I feel hurt and want to protect myself. But then we talk less, and it's not good. It's when I impose unnecessary taboos.

Speaker 1 [00:29:55] Unnecessary, you think?

Speaker 2 [00:30:02] Yes, it's pointless.

Speaker 1 [00:30:04] Yes, pointless.

Speaker 2 [00:30:06] It might protect me at the moment, but later, I take a step back and realize there's no danger. I know the love is there, and it will be fine.

Speaker 1 [00:30:23] You talk about taboos and communication, which we mentioned earlier. I'd like you to elaborate on the role communication plays in your relationship, what it brings or doesn't bring. What can you tell me?

Speaker 2 [00:30:40] Communication brings a lot. Taboos act as a barrier, cutting off communication. Without communication, the relationship can't progress. If there's no exchange with the other, there's no exchange with oneself either. Communication allows us to fully understand each other, listen, grow, question, and challenge each other. It's now a fundamental aspect for me.

Speaker 1 [00:31:41] Yes, it's a fundamental aspect.

Speaker 2 [00:31:43] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:31:44] Is it something...

Speaker 2 [00:31:46] I know it's not easy. If [partner] and I were to break up and I had someone else, I know it would be very hard to have this level of communication with someone else. I talk a lot, but he always asks very pertinent questions that make me think differently about things.

Speaker 1 [00:32:26] So, it's not just communication in general, but also pertinent communication that's important for you?

Speaker 2 [00:32:37] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:32:41] If I understand what you said, communication helps you know the other person, yourself, and build the relationship. It's the foundation.

Speaker 2 [00:32:57] It allows us to question things and move forward together. What we think today might change tomorrow. We evolve; we're not the same as we were [6-10] or [16-20] years ago.

Speaker 1 [00:33:40] You also talked earlier about freedom—the freedom you feel or give in the relationship. I'd like you to elaborate on the importance of this notion for you in a romantic relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:34:00] It's really about the freedom to be oneself. At the beginning of our relationship, [partner] questioned what love was, why, and how. He talked to me about polyamory, which I couldn't accept. We discussed it a lot, trying to understand why. If we didn't have the freedom to talk, I wouldn't have been able to explore these ideas. Over time, he realized that if I had someone else, he wouldn't handle it well. These are things we can talk about freely. I don't have to justify my actions, my spending, or my choices. I'm free but still have someone in my life. We share many things together. Being free to be oneself without hiding or feeling ashamed is important.

Speaker 1 [00:36:20] Yes, you describe the possibility of being oneself in the relationship, expressing your identity without fear of judgment or being out of place. This notion of freedom is also linked to communication, right?

Speaker 2 [00:36:39] Yes, yes, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:36:44] You talked about what constitutes a high-quality relationship for you. I'd like to know what constitutes a low-quality relationship for you.

Speaker 2 [00:36:55] The first thing is the lack of exchange and sharing. With my ex, maybe he saw it differently, but there was no discussion, no compatibility in many aspects, including sexually. Without discussion and exchange, the relationship can't progress. Truthfulness, both in facts and in oneself, is also crucial.

Speaker 1 [00:38:13] Yes. You said you carried everything.

Speaker 2 [00:38:18] Yes, I carried a lot.

Speaker 1 [00:38:21] You carried the relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:38:23] The relationship, the house, the children, the paperwork, the vacations. Today, I carry everything, but it's my house and my children, so I'm much more at peace because I'm not doing it for someone else who should be doing it too.

Speaker 1 [00:38:47] Yes, you talked about the notion of freedom to be oneself, and carrying everything stifled that freedom to develop and be oneself.

Speaker 2 [00:39:06] Yes, it made me bitter because I was angry but didn't express it. It became a vicious circle.

Speaker 1 [00:39:22] A non-virtuous circle, where one problem leads to many other problems in the relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:39:34] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:39:38] You talked about what constitutes a high-quality or low-quality relationship for you. Are there other things that are most important to you in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:39:57] Sexual compatibility is very important. I told my neighbor there's no such thing as bad sex, only bad couples. Sometimes things just don't work with someone, and that's it. Sexual harmony is very important. If things don't go well in that area, it can last a few years but not long term.

Speaker 1 [00:40:29] Yes, you mentioned sexuality. Why is it important to you?

Speaker 2 [00:40:36] It's important because it's a fusion of souls, bodies, and hearts. It's something that deeply connects two people. If we have a dispute or something goes wrong, it's through intimacy that we can reconnect. It's powerful.

Speaker 1 [00:41:15] Yes, it's powerful. It's something that, if I understand you correctly, helps to cement the relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:41:29] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:41:36] Would you say it has a primary and prominent place in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:41:47] I think so, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:41:51] You said, "there's no such thing as bad sex, only bad couples."

Speaker 2 [00:41:56] Yes, I'm convinced of that. It's a matter of compatibility.

Speaker 1 [00:42:04] A match between people, bodies, and souls.

Speaker 2 [00:42:16] I'd like you to tell me, based on your experiences, what love means to you.

Speaker 2 [00:42:28] Love is a meeting of two souls and two hearts that together want to do many things, share many things, discover many things, and face life's events while staying united.

Speaker 1 [00:43:16] But for you? How important is love in a relationship? We know there are different ways to love. I'd like you to tell me how you know your partner loves you.

Speaker 2 [00:43:44] Well, I think he is one of the few people who has truly shown me his love. It's often through little gestures. Each time we see each other, it's small gifts, but they mean a lot. Sometimes it's just a post-it with a note. It's very personalized, and I know he fully knows me to understand what will make me happy. He writes songs for me, and you don't do that if you don't love someone. There are many things you can't do if you don't love the other person. It's in the way we lie down together, in the way we look at each other. It's all these little things that show love.

Speaker 1 [00:44:53] You said there are many things you can't do if you don't love the other person. What do you mean?

Speaker 2 [00:45:01] You can't force yourself to do thoughtful gestures or things that touch the other person's heart if it doesn't come from your own heart.

Speaker 1 [00:45:17] Sincerity.

Speaker 2 [00:45:21] Yes, exactly. It brings joy. It can't be fake. Some things can be fake, but over time, with experience, you develop a better sense of things. You can still be wrong, but you get a better feeling for it.

Speaker 1 [00:45:44] We no longer deceive ourselves about what is sincere and what is not. We can still be wrong, you think?

Speaker 2 [00:45:55] I can't say I'm never wrong. I could be completely mistaken and not see it. But no one is infallible. I'm not [11-15] anymore; I know a bit about men and life through men in general. I talk a lot with people.

Speaker 1 [00:46:30] I'd like you to talk about one of the recent positive interactions you had with [partner].

Speaker 2 [00:46:39] A positive interaction. In a conversation or a moment?

Speaker 1 [00:46:56] What you consider a positive interaction, what comes to your mind?

Speaker 2 [00:47:10] Recently, it goes against our project of living apart, but he is renovating his house to create a small three-story house. Last week, he suggested that when the kids are gone, I could live in one part and he in the other, and we'd have a common bedroom. It was very meaningful because we usually don't make long-term plans. With [partner], it's always about living in the moment. But imagining this future together was a strong exchange. We even pictured having a goat in the garden.

Speaker 1 [00:48:36] You said he has a hard time projecting into the future and focuses on the present. Is that correct?

Speaker 2 [00:48:51] Yes, he often says, "At [46-50], I'll marry you," but he also believes in living in the present because we don't know what tomorrow holds. We can't make long-term plans.

Speaker 1 [00:49:11] On the contrary, can you talk about a negative interaction you had with [partner]?

Speaker 2 [00:49:28] The last one was last night, over a message. We were talking about kids, and I brought up the idea of having triplets, even though he already has [1-5] kids and I have two. Recently, we haven't been using protection because I lost my IUD, and I can't have another one. I don't want hormones, and after a minor procedure, I don't want another one for permanent ligatures. It's a small operation for men but a major one for women. So, we sometimes use condoms, but not always, and for me, it's a dangerous game. I brought up that women bear the burden of contraception their whole lives. It's a huge stress, and while a non-ejaculatory penetration might be safe for men, it's still stressful for women. This turned into a feminist rant. This morning, he said he was reflecting and wanted to make a decision, but I had already stressed him out. It's a stressful topic for me.

Speaker 1 [00:51:24] You said this decision would be made.

Speaker 2 [00:51:27] Yes, supposedly. But he's slow in making decisions. That's just how he is. I turn [36-40] in [Month], and he wanted to tell me then, but I spoiled his announcement.

Speaker 1 [00:51:51] I'd like you to talk about the challenges in your relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:51:58] Continuing to surprise each other and not taking anything for granted. It could end tomorrow.

Speaker 1 [00:52:35] I think I lost you. Ah, no! You're back? All is well. You were talking about the challenges. Have you already overcome any challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:52:49] I think we try to do that daily with [partner]. In a relationship, it's almost obligatory. Living apart, nothing is ever taken for granted. Even those who live together don't take things for granted either. We think it's more secure, but it's not.

Speaker 1 [00:53:28] You described your relationship as a long-distance one.

Speaker 2 [00:53:33] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:53:35] Is it a long-distance relationship for you?

Speaker 2 [00:53:40] In the sense that we don't live together. We're always apart.

Speaker 1 [00:53:49] Yes, I understand what you mean. Is that also a challenge for you? You mentioned feeling the distance.

Speaker 2 [00:54:05] It's not always easy, for him or for me. We try to connect as much as possible, but it's a challenge to manage.

Speaker 1 [00:54:38] We know that not everything is rosy in a relationship. Sometimes there are conflicts. I'd like you to talk about the disputes or conflicts you have with [partner].

Speaker 2 [00:54:54] We don't have many conflicts. Recently, we had a dispute about polyamory. I have a rich social life with many friends, whereas [partner] is more reserved. After moving to [Country], he cut himself off from many things. He has a harder time with friendships. I had significant dialogue issues with my ex about custody arrangements. I might not have been attentive enough. He needs constant deep conversations, and I can't send interesting messages all day. He mentioned needing to seduce and that I might need it too, even if I don't admit it. We agreed to allow each other to flirt, but he recently had an ongoing conversation with a friend's ex, which felt like more than flirting. It led to a major dispute. He didn't hide it, but it was a source of conflict.

Speaker 1 [00:58:09] You distinguished between seduction and flirting. Can you elaborate?

Speaker 2 [00:58:15] We discussed it, and he understood my limits. We realized we hadn't fully communicated our boundaries.

Speaker 1 [00:58:29] So, you drew a line between superficial and intimate interactions.

Speaker 2 [00:59:10] Yes, that might be the limit.

Speaker 1 [00:59:34] We talked about conflicts. How often do major conflicts like this occur?

Speaker 2 [00:59:55] It's rare. I sometimes keep my thoughts to myself. Major conflicts happen once or twice in [1-5] and a half years.

Speaker 1 [01:00:30] How do you resolve these conflicts?

Speaker 2 [01:00:37] We talk.

Speaker 1 [01:00:38] You talk.

Speaker 2 [01:00:42] We talk and talk.

Speaker 1 [01:00:45] Communication helps resolve tensions.

Speaker 2 [01:00:50] Yes, to understand why.

Speaker 1 [01:00:53] You mentioned earlier that sexuality can help resolve conflicts. Is that true?

Speaker 2 [01:01:09] Yes. Reconnecting physically helps.

Speaker 1 [01:01:18] It brings back sincerity.

Speaker 2 [01:01:26] Besides communication, how else do you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [01:01:37] Through attentions, tenderness, and love. Doing things together and sharing.

Speaker 1 [01:01:55] Sharing.

Speaker 2 [01:01:58] Sharing life moments.

Speaker 1 [01:02:04] What could make you leave your partner?

Speaker 2 [01:02:18] If we no longer loved each other or lost that connection.

Speaker 1 [01:02:33] Yes. Do you think you are the same person you were before the relationship?

Speaker 2 [01:02:48] No.

Speaker 1 [01:02:50] No.

Speaker 2 [01:02:51] No, he has opened me up to many things. We talked a lot, learning about each other and ourselves. He introduced me to new sexual possibilities, nature, and other interests. I've grown a lot with him, and he calms me. He is very calm and reflective. He balances me.

Speaker 1 [01:04:03] He balances you. So, the relationship helps regulate yourself.

Speaker 2 [01:04:31] Yes, I think so. He's learning to be more himself and gain confidence.

Speaker 1 [01:04:54] Was confidence something he lacked before?

Speaker 2 [01:04:58] Yes, he tended to devalue himself. My high regard for him helps him gain confidence.

Speaker 1 [01:05:30] Do you feel secure in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [01:05:35] Yes.

Speaker 1 [01:05:41] Tell me more.

Speaker 2 [01:05:45] It's contradictory because many women wouldn't feel secure with an ever-present ex. But he provides that security. His way of reassuring me leaves little room for doubt. In such a relationship, trust and security are essential for it to be viable.

Speaker 1 [01:06:47] At the beginning, you mentioned the freedom to be yourself, which contributes to this sense of security. Can you give an example of a time when you felt you could truly express yourself?

Speaker 2 [01:07:15] With him or with others?

Speaker 1 [01:07:21] Yes, if you think it's related to the relationship.

Speaker 2 [01:07:30] As I mentioned earlier, after COVID, we both had similar views and didn't get vaccinated, becoming societal outcasts. Being with him gave me the strength to face my family and colleagues, knowing someone understood me. It helped me stand by my choice.

Speaker 1 [01:08:37] And with him, you said...

Speaker 2 [01:08:54] I've always been myself with him.

Speaker 1 [01:08:59] From the beginning.

Speaker 2 [01:09:03] From the beginning, we talked a lot. I learned from past relationships where I kept quiet for years. Now, we say everything and hide nothing.

Speaker 1 [01:09:38] Yes, we express who we are to avoid suffocating. It becomes an imperative.

Speaker 2 [01:09:44] Yes, it's essential.

Speaker 1 [01:09:53] Security also comes from comfort and attention from the partner in times of danger or distress. Is this something you recognize?

Speaker 2 [01:10:12] Yes. He is a shoulder to lean on, even when not physically present. He knows how to make me feel secure and calm me, whether we're together or apart.

Speaker 1 [01:10:48] Do you have an example of a time when he provided this comfort?

Speaker 2 [01:11:07] There are many times because I tend to dramatize things quickly. Recently, I had issues with my house's terrace. It felt like a disaster, but he reassured me, helping me see that solutions exist and there are worse problems. His calmness helps me take things step by step.

Speaker 1 [01:12:08] You talked earlier about the importance of sexuality in the relationship, as a foundation and a way to gauge compatibility.

Speaker 2 [01:12:27] Yes.

Speaker 1 [01:12:29] Would you say you are satisfied with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [01:12:32] Yes.

Speaker 1 [01:12:33] Yes.

Speaker 2 [01:12:34] Yes, because it involves many different aspects. I mentioned dominance earlier, but it's not just that. It's part of it, but we have a very compatible sex life. Maybe living apart helps build desire. In my past relationship, it was very complicated, but with him, we are in sync and compatible.

Speaker 1 [01:13:35] You mentioned discovering new practices and being initiated into new things.

Speaker 2 [01:13:46] Yes, we always share and explore together, without taboos. It's a shared discovery.

Speaker 1 [01:14:05] Sharing is very important to you?

Speaker 2 [01:14:10] Yes.

Speaker 1 [01:14:13] Currently, what is the frequency of your sexual relations?

Speaker 2 [01:14:19] Every day we see each other, I think.

Speaker 1 [01:14:25] Yes, you mentioned that not seeing each other and then reuniting helps build desire.

Speaker 2 [01:14:33] Yes, or every other day. Initially, it was daily. Now, maybe not every day, but almost.

Speaker 1 [01:14:51] I will share my screen and show you a scale. I'd like you to respond to two of its items. Tell me when you see it. All good. Generally, my partner really listens to me. It ranges from 1 to 9, with 1 being not at all true and 9 being completely true. Where would you place it?

Speaker 2 [01:15:32] I'd say completely true. I think he might say slightly less. For me, it's nine.

Speaker 1 [01:15:41] Why nine?

Speaker 2 [01:15:44] Because he is really actively listening. He is very attentive. He prefers intimate settings for genuine exchanges. It's very important to him. He is completely attentive to others and to me.

Speaker 1 [01:16:26] Why not eight, for example?

Speaker 2 [01:16:32] Because I don't think he could listen to me more.

Speaker 1 [01:16:43] My partner is generally attentive to my needs. On the same scale.

Speaker 2 [01:16:49] The same, I think.

Speaker 1 [01:16:52] The first was generally listens to me. The second is generally attentive to my needs.

Speaker 2 [01:17:03] I'd say eight.

Speaker 1 [01:17:11] Why eight?

Speaker 2 [01:17:13] Because of what I mentioned earlier about contraception. We've been waiting for months, and he's slow to decide. In the meantime, risks are taken, and I need security in that area. Otherwise, everything else is fine.

Speaker 1 [01:17:51] Yes, exactly.

Speaker 2 [01:17:54] Yes.

Speaker 1 [01:17:57] How satisfied are you with your relationship, from completely dissatisfied to completely satisfied?

Speaker 2 [01:18:14] Very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [01:18:16] Yes, so on a numerical scale from 0 to 10, with 0 being not at all satisfied and 10 being completely satisfied, where would you place it?

Speaker 2 [01:18:29] Nine.

Speaker 1 [01:18:32] Why nine?

Speaker 2 [01:18:34] Because I still want to be with him often, and the situation with his ex isn't entirely resolved. There are small things that need adjusting.

Speaker 1 [01:19:02] Why not eight?

Speaker 2 [01:19:09] Because I think I've never found someone else in my life who brings what he does.

Speaker 1 [01:19:19] The ability to be yourself, share, and be in sync.

Speaker 2 [01:19:25] Exactly.

Speaker 1 [01:19:28] Very well. We're nearing the end of the interview. Is there anything you'd like to add, clarify, or correct?

Speaker 2 [01:19:47] I don't think so. I think we covered the topic well.

Speaker 1 [01:19:51] Yes, you think so?

Speaker 2 [01:19:52] Yes.

Speaker 1 [01:19:54] Take your time to reflect. Maybe there's something you wanted to say but didn't.

Speaker 2 [01:20:11] No, I don't think so.

Speaker 1 [01:20:15] I believe I lost you for a moment, but I think I heard you.

Speaker 2 [01:20:22] I have a very weak signal.

Speaker 1 [01:20:25] That's alright. It's the end of the interview.

Speaker 2 [01:20:27] It's okay.

Speaker 1 [01:20:30] Anything else to add?

Speaker 2 [01:20:32] No, that's all.

Speaker 1 [01:20:34] Very well. I'll stop the recording now.